V1 example run: the blue button story

One small story, scene by scene. Each scene shows what happened, what Ember does, and what Ember holds afterwards.

AI suggests · Automatic check (no AI) · You decide · Saved

This story is an illustration. A real AI may suggest different items or links. The steps for closing, flagging, reading, and resetting were replayed with the real commands on 2026-10-30, and the results match.

Scene 1: the first notes

The team chats after testing the app. Both lines are worth keeping.

> "Blue buttons failed the contrast test."
> "We decided: dark green buttons."

1. AI suggests
   Capture: two items
   The AI suggests a Finding and a Decision.
2. Automatic check
   Capture: checks
   The types are allowed and the quotes appear in the source.
3. You decide
   Capture: you confirm
   You say yes to both.
   Command: `ember capture`
4. AI suggests
   Relate: one link
   The AI suggests that the Decision depends on the Finding. The automatic check confirms this kind of link is allowed here.
5. You decide
   Relate: you confirm
   You say yes.
   Command: `ember relate --latest`

EMBER NOW HOLDS

FINDING · ACTIVE · NEW
Blue buttons failed the contrast test

DECISION · ACTIVE · NEW
Use dark green buttons

Link: the Decision depends on the Finding

Scene 2: an open question

Someone asks, and nobody knows yet.

> "Does dark green pass the test?"

1. AI suggests
   Capture: one item
   The AI suggests a Question.
2. You decide
   Capture: you confirm
   You say yes. Nothing else changes.
   Command: `ember capture`

EMBER NOW HOLDS

FINDING · ACTIVE
Blue buttons failed the contrast test

DECISION · ACTIVE
Use dark green buttons

QUESTION · ACTIVE · NEW
Does dark green pass the test?

Scene 3: the answer arrives

A new test says dark green passes. It answers the Question and backs up the Decision.

1 — AI suggests

Capture: one item

The AI suggests a new Finding.

2 — You decide

Capture: you confirm

You say yes.

Command: `ember capture`

3 — AI suggests

Relate: two links

The AI suggests that the Finding answers the Question and supports the Decision.

4 — You decide

Relate: you confirm

You say yes to both.

Command: `ember relate --latest`

5 — Automatic check

Maintain: the answer closes the Question

You run the sweep. Rule 2 closes the Question as answered.

Command: `ember maintain`

EMBER NOW HOLDS

FINDING · ACTIVE
Blue buttons failed the contrast test

DECISION · ACTIVE
Use dark green buttons

QUESTION · CLOSED: ANSWERED
Does dark green pass the test?

FINDING · ACTIVE · NEW
Dark green passes the new test

Link: the new Finding answers the Question

Link: the new Finding supports the Decision

Scene 4: a surprise

Later the team finds that the first test was set up wrong. The blue result cannot be trusted.

1 — You decide

You close the first Finding

You close it as invalidated (found to be wrong).

Command: `ember close-item --item 1 --reason invalidated`

2 — Automatic check

Maintain: the knock-on rule

The Decision depends on that Finding. Rule 4 marks the Decision as Challenged.

EMBER NOW HOLDS

FINDING · CLOSED: INVALIDATED
Blue buttons failed the contrast test

DECISION · CHALLENGED
Use dark green buttons

QUESTION · CLOSED: ANSWERED
Does dark green pass the test?

FINDING · ACTIVE
Dark green passes the new test

Scene 5: reading it back

Someone asks:

> “Why did we pick green?”

Automatic check

1

Query: the reasons

Ember shows the Decision, marked Challenged, with the two items it rests on: the closed Finding and the new Finding that supports it.

Commands: `ember current-state`, `ember why --item 2`

You decide

2

You recheck

The new Finding still backs the Decision up. You set the Decision back to Active.

Command: `ember set-status --item 2 --to Active`

EMBER NOW HOLDS

FINDING · CLOSED: INVALIDATED
Blue buttons failed the contrast test

DECISION · ACTIVE · SET BY YOU
Use dark green buttons

QUESTION · CLOSED: ANSWERED
Does dark green pass the test?

FINDING · ACTIVE
Dark green passes the new test

Checked against the code on 2026-10-30. The big picture is in the master diagram. Every command is listed in `docs/commands.md`.